GRADE 5 ELA

Topic 2: Literature and Reading Comprehension

Common Core–aligned multiple-choice question bank

150 original questions • 50 Easy • 50 Medium • 50 Hard

Skills include close reading, textual evidence, inference, summary, theme, plot, character motivation and development, setting, point of view, figurative language, mood, symbolism, and drawing conclusions from literary passages.

Instructions: Read each short passage carefully, then select the best answer. The answer key is provided at the end. Correct answer positions are balanced across A–D.

Easy Questions (50)

1. Read the passage: **The Lantern**

Mara carried the old lantern up the hill, although the moon lit most of the path. At the summit, she found her grandfather waiting beside a broken fence. He smiled when he saw the lantern. “You remembered,” he said. Mara had almost stayed home because the lantern seemed unnecessary, but now she understood why he had asked her to bring it: its warm glow made the hidden gate visible.

Question: Why did Mara bring the lantern to the hill?

A. She wanted to read a book outdoors

B. Her grandfather had asked her to bring it

C. The moon had disappeared behind clouds

D. She planned to repair the fence alone

2. Read the passage: **A Seat by the Window**

Every morning, Luis chose the seat by the library window. He liked watching the school garden change through the seasons. In September, tiny green shoots appeared; by December, frost covered the soil. One rainy day, he noticed a student sitting alone with a book held over her face. Luis moved his backpack and invited her to sit beside him. The garden could wait; someone needed company.

Question: How does the setting help shape the passage?

A. The garden is the main place where the students meet

B. The rainy weather prevents every student from reading

C. The changing garden marks the passage of time

D. The library window keeps Luis from studying

3. Read the passage: **The Last Kite**

Nia’s kite had a blue tail and a patch shaped like a star. When a gust tore the string from her hand, it sailed over the fence into Mr. Bell’s orchard. Nia expected him to scold her, because he guarded his trees carefully. Instead, he brought out a long pole and helped retrieve it. “Fruit trees need care,” he said, “but so do people’s hopes.” Nia thanked him and promised to keep her kite away from the branches.

Question: What problem does Nia face?

A. Her kite has no tail

B. A storm destroys the trees

C. Mr. Bell loses his pole

D. Her kite blows into the orchard

4. Read the passage: **The New Part**

During rehearsal, Theo missed the same line three times. Each time, he glanced at the audience seats and imagined everyone laughing. His friend Amira suggested that he mark the line in bright pencil and practice it while walking around the empty stage. After several tries, the words came naturally. On opening night, Theo still felt nervous, but he no longer feared the line.

Question: What is Theo’s main difficulty at first?

A. He worries that the audience will laugh at him

B. He cannot find the rehearsal room

C. He does not know who his friend is

D. He wants to change the play’s ending

5. Read the passage: **The Map in the Attic**

While helping clean the attic, Suri found a map tucked inside a cookbook. It showed the town square, the old bridge, and a small drawing of a bell near the river. Her aunt recognized the handwriting as her great-grandmother's. Together they followed the map and discovered a bronze bell stored in the historical society. A note explained that it had once rung to announce the start of the town fair.

Question: Where does Suri discover the map?

A. Inside a cookbook in the attic

B. In a display at the historical society

C. Beside the bell in the town square

D. Under the bridge near the river

6. Read the passage: **The Quiet Contest**

The science fair rewarded the loudest demonstrations with crowds, but Priya's project made almost no sound. She had built a simple filter that cleaned muddy water using sand, gravel, and charcoal. One judge watched her pour the same water through the filter twice. The second sample was clearer. Priya did not win the largest display prize, but she earned the award for practical design.

Question: Why does Priya's project attract fewer spectators?

A. It takes place outside the fair building

B. It is not allowed to use water

C. It is quiet compared with the loud demonstrations

D. It uses too many flashing lights

7. Read the passage: **The Borrowed Book**

Owen borrowed a book of myths from the classroom shelf and promised to return it on Friday. On Thursday, he found that a page had come loose. He could have placed it back without telling anyone, but he took the book to Ms. Chen and explained what happened. She thanked him for being honest and showed him how to repair the page with archival tape.

Question: What choice does Owen face?

A. Whether to admit that a page came loose

B. Whether to read the book aloud on Friday

C. Whether to borrow a book of science facts

D. Whether to change the classroom shelf

8. Read the passage: **A Different Route**

The bus usually took the main road to school, but construction blocked the bridge one Tuesday. At first, the passengers groaned as the driver turned onto a narrow street. Then they passed a bakery where warm rolls filled the air with a sweet smell and a mural showing the town's history. By the time they reached school, several students were discussing the things they had never noticed before.

Question: Why does the bus take a different route?

A. The driver wants to visit a bakery

B. The main road is always too narrow

C. Construction blocks the usual bridge

D. The students ask to see a mural

9. Read the passage: **The Paper Bridge**

For the engineering challenge, each team had to build a bridge from paper and tape. Malik folded his sheets into narrow beams, while Zoe rolled hers into tubes. Their first bridge sagged under three books. Instead of arguing about whose idea had failed, they combined the beams and tubes. The new bridge held six books before bending. They wrote down the result, including what still needed improvement.

Question: What causes the team's first bridge to fail?

A. It sags under the weight of three books

B. They use too much metal wire

C. The challenge requires a wooden bridge

D. They forget to bring any paper

10. Read the passage: **The Old Oak**

A sign announced that the old oak beside the playground would be removed because its largest branch was damaged. Students gathered around it after lunch. Their teacher asked them to measure its trunk, sketch its shape, and write memories connected to the tree. On Friday, the class planted two young oaks in another part of the schoolyard. The old tree was gone, but its story became part of the school's history.

Question: Why is the old oak scheduled for removal?

A. Its leaves have turned green

B. Its largest branch is damaged

C. The class wants more room for games

D. The teacher plans to build a classroom there

11. Read the passage: **The Midnight Visitor**

A scratching sound woke Elena just after midnight. She crept downstairs and saw a shadow move across the kitchen wall. Her heart raced until she switched on the light. A small hedgehog stood beside the open back door, its nose twitching. Elena placed a laundry basket over it gently and called the wildlife rescue number printed on the fridge.

Question: What creates suspense at the beginning?

A. A rescue worker knocks at the front door

B. Elena reads a wildlife guide at breakfast

C. Elena hears scratching and sees a moving shadow

D. The hedgehog sleeps quietly in a basket

12. Read the passage: **The Promise**

Before moving away, Ben promised his neighbor Mrs. Ortiz that he would send a postcard from every place he visited. His first card showed a mountain. The second showed a crowded city. Months passed before the third arrived, showing only a small beach near his new home. Mrs. Ortiz placed all three cards on her mantel and smiled; the promise had kept their friendship alive across the distance.

Question: What promise does Ben make?

A. To call his neighbor every morning

B. To send a postcard from each place he visits

C. To return to the neighborhood every month

D. To bring Mrs. Ortiz a souvenir from the mountains

13. Read the passage: **The Snow Day**

When school closed because of snow, Amari planned to build the tallest snow fort on the block. His younger sister could not lift the heavy packed snow, so he made a smaller section she could shape herself. By afternoon, their fort was not the tallest, but it had a tunnel, a flag, and a place for both of them to sit. Their neighbors asked to join the game.

Question: What changes Amari's original plan?

A. The snow melts before lunch

B. Their neighbors tell them to stop

C. His sister needs a part she can help build

D. He discovers that forts cannot have tunnels

14. Read the passage: **The Song Collector**

Mr. Ade kept a notebook of songs sung at family celebrations. Some were lively songs everyone knew; others were short verses remembered only by his grandmother. When she could no longer sing for long, he recorded her humming and wrote down the words she remembered. Years later, his grandchildren used the notebook to teach the songs at a family gathering.

Question: What does Mr. Ade collect?

A. Songs and verses from family celebrations

B. Tickets from concerts around the world

C. Photographs of every family member

D. Recipes from neighborhood restaurants

15. Read the passage: **The Empty Frame**

A museum displayed an empty frame with a label explaining that the painting inside had been stolen decades earlier. Visitors often passed it without stopping. One day, a child asked why the museum did not simply replace the painting. The guide explained that the empty space reminded people of the loss and of the work still being done to recover stolen art. The child looked again and read the label carefully.

Question: Why is the frame left empty?

A. It reminds visitors about the stolen painting and the effort to recover it

B. The guide does not know how to hang artwork

C. The frame is too small for any painting

D. The museum has decided that paintings are no longer useful

16. Read the passage: **The Race at River Park**

Tessa trained for the river park race each morning, but on race day she noticed a younger runner sitting beside the course with a twisted ankle. She called for an adult and stayed until help arrived. By then, the leading runners had passed. Tessa finished far behind her personal goal, yet the race organizer thanked her publicly for acting quickly and responsibly.

Question: Why does Tessa fall behind in the race?

A. She forgets where the course begins

B. She stops to get help for an injured runner

C. She decides to leave the race before it starts

D. She spends time tying a loose shoelace

17. Read the passage: **The Strange Footprints**

After a night of rain, footprints crossed the soft garden soil and ended beneath the shed. Noah guessed they belonged to a fox, but his sister measured the prints and noticed they were much smaller than a fox's. They found a trail of sunflower seeds leading to a hole in the shed wall. A family of mice had been visiting the bird feeder.

Question: What evidence challenges Noah's first guess?

A. The bird feeder is painted green

B. The garden soil is soft after rain

C. The shed has a wall and a roof

D. The footprints are smaller than a fox's prints

18. Read the passage: **The Borrowed Violin**

Asha's music teacher lent her a violin for the weekend concert. At home, Asha practiced slowly, stopping whenever a note sounded rough. Her brother suggested playing faster so the mistakes would be harder to hear. Asha shook her head and repeated the difficult measures until each note was clear. At the concert, her hands trembled at first, then settled into the music.

Question: How does Asha prepare for the concert?

A. She asks the teacher to perform in her place

B. She follows her brother's advice to play faster

C. She avoids practicing the rough notes

D. She repeats difficult measures carefully

19. Read the passage: **The Garden Debate**

The class voted on what to plant in its garden. Most students wanted bright flowers, while Hana argued for vegetables. She brought a chart showing how much sunlight each plant needed and explained that the vegetables could be donated to the community kitchen. The class voted again and chose both vegetables and flowers, arranging them in separate beds.

Question: What is Hana's main argument?

A. The class should stop voting on garden decisions

B. Flowers are impossible to grow in school gardens

C. Vegetables could help the community kitchen and suit the garden plan

D. Vegetables need no sunlight or care

20. Read the passage: **A Letter from the Past**

While sorting family papers, Darius found a letter written by his great-aunt when she was his age. She described walking several miles to school and sharing one classroom with children of different ages. Darius had complained that his school bus arrived too early. After reading the letter, he asked his great-aunt what she remembered most about school. Her answer began a conversation that lasted all afternoon.

Question: What does the letter describe?

A. Plans to build a larger classroom

B. The great-aunt's experiences as a student

C. Darius's first day at a new school

D. A trip the family took overseas

21. Read the passage: **The Windy Field**

The soccer team practiced in a field where the wind pushed every high pass sideways. The coach asked the players to keep the ball low and pass along the ground. At first, several players complained that the drill was boring. Soon they noticed that their passes became more accurate, even when the wind grew stronger. During the next match, they used the same strategy to keep possession.

Question: What challenge affects the team's practice?

A. The field is too small for soccer

B. The coach cancels every drill

C. Strong wind changes the path of high passes

D. The team has no ball to use

22. Read the passage: **The Cracked Bowl**

Grandma used a blue bowl with a thin crack along its rim. She never served soup in it anymore, but she filled it with orange marigolds and placed it on the kitchen table. When Eli offered to buy a new bowl, she laughed. "This one still has a job," she said. Eli began noticing other repaired or reused objects around the house, each with its own story.

Question: Why does Grandma use the cracked bowl for flowers?

A. She has forgotten where the other bowls are stored

B. The bowl is too new to hold food

C. It can still be useful even though it is no longer suitable for soup

D. She wants the flowers to hide the kitchen table

23. Read the passage: **The Secret Ingredient**

Mina followed her father's recipe for vegetable stew, but the taste was flat. She checked the list twice and discovered she had skipped the lemon juice. After adding a small amount, she stirred and tasted again. The flavor brightened. Her father explained that the juice did not make the stew taste like lemons; it helped the other flavors stand out.

Question: What causes the stew to taste flat at first?

A. The recipe contains no vegetables

B. Her father forgets to cook the vegetables

C. Mina leaves out the lemon juice

D. She adds too much lemon juice

24. Read the passage: **The Lighthouse Keeper**

During a storm, the lighthouse beam flickered twice. Keeper Rowan climbed the narrow stairs and found a loose connection in the lamp housing. The wind shook the windows, but he tightened the fitting and checked the light again. Far offshore, a fishing boat changed direction toward the safer channel. Rowan watched until the beam shone steadily across the water.

Question: What problem does Rowan discover?

A. A loose connection affects the lighthouse lamp

B. The fishing boat has lost its engine

C. The safer channel is blocked by rocks

D. The stairs have collapsed in the storm

25. Read the passage: **The Forgotten Lunch**

At noon, Sam opened his backpack and realized his lunch was still on the kitchen counter. He considered skipping lunch, but his classmate Noor offered to split her sandwich. Sam accepted half and promised to bring an extra snack the next day. When Noor forgot her water bottle later that week, Sam shared his spare bottle of water.

Question: What problem does Sam have at lunchtime?

A. He cannot find the classroom kitchen

B. He has left his lunch at home

C. He has forgotten how to open his lunchbox

D. He has lost his backpack on the bus

26. Read the passage: **The Chalk Drawing**

A rainstorm washed away the chalk animals that Jo and her neighbors had drawn on the sidewalk. Jo felt disappointed, but her neighbor pointed out the bright colors spreading in the puddles. The next morning, they drew new animals with thicker outlines and added a little sign: “Temporary art—come make some.” By afternoon, children from three streets had joined them.

Question: Why is Jo disappointed?

A. The colors are too bright to see

B. The neighbors refuse to draw animals

C. The sidewalk is closed for repairs

D. The rain washes away the chalk drawings

27. Read the passage: **The Library Clock**

The clock above the library desk was five minutes fast. Most students did not notice, but Mr. Hale checked it against his watch every morning. When the clock stopped completely, the librarian asked students to estimate the time using the sunlit windows and the school bell schedule while maintenance came. Their guesses varied, so they learned why a reliable clock mattered.

Question: What do students do when the clock stops?

A. They close the library for the rest of the year

B. They remove the windows to let in more light

C. They decide that time no longer matters

D. They estimate time using other clues and the bell schedule

28. Read the passage: **The Painted Bench**

The park bench had peeling green paint, so a group of volunteers offered to restore it. At first, they argued over whether to keep it green or choose a brighter color. An older resident explained that the bench had been green since the park opened. The volunteers kept the original color, sanded the wood, and added a small plaque thanking the people who had cared for the park.

Question: What disagreement occurs among the volunteers?

A. They disagree about where the park is located

B. They want to remove every bench

C. They cannot decide which color to use

D. They cannot find any paint at all

29. Read the passage: **The Puzzle Tournament**

Leah solved the first puzzle quickly, then rushed through the second and missed an important clue. Her teammate reminded her that the team earned points only for correct solutions. Leah slowed down, reread the instructions, and found the hidden pattern. They finished with fewer attempted puzzles than some teams, but their answers were accurate.

Question: Why does Leah miss a clue in the second puzzle?

A. She rushes instead of reading carefully

B. She has already solved the final puzzle

C. She refuses to work with her teammate

D. The instructions are missing from the page

30. Read the passage: **The Winter Birds**

When winter arrived, fewer birds visited the school garden. A group of students wanted to scatter bread crumbs, but their teacher helped them research suitable foods for local birds. They built a feeder and filled it with seeds recommended by a wildlife guide. Soon, small birds returned. The students recorded which species visited and changed the feeder's position to keep it away from prowling cats.

Question: Why do students research bird food before filling the feeder?

A. They plan to stop observing wildlife

B. They want to attract cats to the garden

C. They want to choose food that is suitable for local birds

D. They need to prove that bread crumbs are expensive

31. Read the passage: **The Train Window**

On the train, Ravi watched the city give way to fields, then to low hills. His grandmother told him that the route had once taken twice as long because the tracks curved around a marsh. Ravi asked why the railway had not simply crossed the marsh. She described the engineers' concern about soft ground and the damage construction might cause to the wetland.

Question: What change does Ravi observe during the journey?

A. The train stops at every farm

B. The tracks disappear under a river

C. The train changes into a bus

D. The scenery shifts from city to fields and hills

32. Read the passage: **The First Snowflake**

Milo pressed his nose to the window and waited for the first snowflake. When one finally drifted down, he called his sister, who was busy finishing a drawing. By the time she arrived, the flake had melted on the sill. Milo apologized for interrupting her, but she laughed and pointed outside: hundreds of flakes were beginning to fall.

Question: Why does Milo call his sister?

A. He wants her to close the window

B. He wants her to see the first snowflake

C. He needs her to finish his drawing

D. He thinks she has lost a mitten

33. Read the passage: **The Mystery of the Missing Pages**

The class novel seemed to jump from chapter four to chapter six. Instead of accusing the student who had borrowed it last, the class checked the reading corner, the teacher’s desk, and the return basket. They found the missing pages folded inside a notebook used as a bookmark. The student who had borrowed the novel apologized for not noticing them.

Question: What problem does the class discover?

A. Pages are missing between two chapters

B. The reading corner has been moved

C. The teacher has borrowed every book

D. The novel has no title page

34. Read the passage: **The Shell Necklace**

At the shore, Amina collected shells for a necklace. Her cousin warned her not to take the striped shell from a tide pool because a tiny animal was tucked inside it. Amina returned the shell to the water and chose empty ones from the sand instead. The necklace looked different from the one she had imagined, but she liked knowing the tide-pool creature could remain safe.

Question: Why does Amina return the striped shell?

A. Her cousin wants to keep it as a souvenir

B. The tide is too low to collect shells

C. The shell is too large for the necklace

D. A small animal is living inside it

35. Read the passage: **The School Newspaper**

Editors of the school newspaper disagreed about the headline for an article on cafeteria waste. One group wanted “Lunchroom Disaster,” while another suggested “Students Find Ways to Waste Less.” Their adviser asked which headline fairly represented the article, which described both the problem and a new composting plan. The editors chose a headline that informed readers without exaggerating.

Question: What causes the editors to disagree?

A. They disagree about when school begins

B. They prefer different headlines for the article

C. They cannot agree on the cafeteria menu

D. They want to cancel the composting plan

36. Read the passage: **The Stone in the Path**

A large stone blocked the path to the community garden. Several people stepped around it and continued on. Young Mateo fetched a sturdy board and asked two neighbors to help lever the stone aside. It took longer than expected, and they had to change their position twice. When the path was clear, an older gardener thanked them because her cart could now pass.

Question: What do most people do when they see the stone?

A. They paint it bright red

B. They walk around it

C. They close the garden

D. They carry it alone

37. Read the passage: **The Unfinished Song**

Mira's mother used to sing a lullaby that ended with a line Mira could never remember. After her mother moved overseas for work, Mira asked relatives if they knew the missing words. Each remembered a slightly different ending. Mira sent the versions to her mother, who replied with a voice message singing the line exactly as she had learned it from her own mother.

Question: What is Mira trying to discover?

A. The missing final line of a family lullaby

B. The name of her mother's new workplace

C. The date of a family celebration

D. The words to a song from school

38. Read the passage: **The Two Invitations**

On the same Saturday, Kai received invitations to a robotics workshop and his cousin's birthday picnic. He wanted to attend both, but the times overlapped. After checking the workshop schedule, he learned that the final hour would be repeated the following week. He went to the picnic and arranged to attend the repeated workshop session later.

Question: What problem must Kai solve?

A. Two events take place at overlapping times

B. He has not received any invitations

C. His cousin refuses to hold a picnic

D. The workshop has been canceled forever

39. Read the passage: **The Glass Jar**

Every time the family visited the beach, they placed one smooth pebble in a glass jar. At first, the jar held only a few stones. Years later, it was nearly full. When the youngest child asked which pebble was the most important, her father said that no single one mattered most; together, they showed how many days the family had spent exploring.

Question: What does the family put in the jar?

A. A photograph from every birthday

B. A written story after every meal

C. One smooth pebble from each beach visit

D. A shell from every shop they visit

40. Read the passage: **The Brave Apology**

During group work, Felix told the class that his teammate had lost their notes. Later, he discovered that he had left the notes in his own locker. He thought about staying quiet because no one had challenged him. Instead, he explained the mistake to the group and apologized. His teammate accepted the apology, and they recreated the notes together.

Question: What mistake does Felix make?

A. He forgets which class he is in

B. He throws away the group's finished project

C. He blames his teammate before checking his own locker

D. He refuses to share the notes with anyone

41. Read the passage: **The Night Train**

The train rattled through the dark countryside while Imani read the same paragraph three times. Across the aisle, a little boy pressed his forehead to the glass and counted the lights of distant houses. His mother whispered that each light belonged to someone ending a day. Imani lowered her book and began to watch the scattered windows too, imagining the lives behind them.

Question: Which point of view is used in the passage?

A. Second person, because the reader is addressed directly

B. Third person, because the narrator knows no thoughts

C. A play script, because characters speak aloud

D. First person, because the narrator says “I”

42. Read the passage: **The Rain Barrel**

The school garden often needed water during dry weeks. After a lesson about conservation, the class placed a rain barrel beneath a roof drain. The first storm filled it almost to the top. When the next dry spell came, students used the stored water on their plants. They made a chart comparing how much tap water they used before and after the barrel was installed.

Question: What purpose does the rain barrel serve?

A. It measures the height of every plant

B. It keeps rain from reaching the roof

C. It stores rainwater for use in the garden

D. It replaces the garden’s soil

43. Read the passage: **The Marble Champion**

At recess, everyone wanted to challenge Sefa, the best marble player in class. When a new student lost every round, Sefa noticed that he kept aiming too high. Rather than taking another turn, Sefa showed him how to steady his thumb and aim at the ground near the target. The next day, the new student won a round and grinned at Sefa across the playground.

Question: Why does Sefa stop to help the new student?

A. He is tired of playing marbles forever

B. He wants to leave the playground early

C. He notices a technique the student can improve

D. He needs the student to lend him a marble

44. Read the passage: **The Museum of Small Things**

For a class exhibition, each student brought an ordinary object with a story. Lila chose a bent spoon from her family’s camping box. It had been used to stir soup during a stormy night when her family’s tent leaked and everyone huddled under a tarp. Visitors first laughed at the spoon’s shape, then listened closely as Lila described the night it reminded her of.

Question: Why does Lila choose the bent spoon?

A. It reminds her of a meaningful family experience

B. It is the most expensive object she owns

C. She wants to show that the spoon is useless

D. Her teacher requires every object to be made of metal

45. Read the passage: **The Lost Dog Poster**

After a dog disappeared from the neighborhood, the children made posters with a clear photograph, the dog's name, and a phone number. One child wanted to add a long description of the dog's favorite games, but the group kept the poster brief so people could read it while walking past. Two days later, a shopkeeper called the number after spotting the dog near the market.

Question: Why does the group keep the poster brief?

A. The shopkeeper has asked them to use fewer colors

B. They want to hide the phone number

C. People need to read the key information quickly

D. They do not know the dog's name

46. Read the passage: **The Orchard Path**

Grandfather walked slowly along the orchard path, stopping at trees he had planted as a young man. He showed Niko a pear tree with a split trunk that still produced fruit. "A storm damaged it," he said, "but we supported the branch and gave it time." Niko had been frustrated about a failed school project. On the walk home, he decided to revise his plan instead of abandoning it.

Question: What does Grandfather show Niko?

A. A storm cloud above the orchard

B. A damaged pear tree that still produces fruit

C. A path that leads to the school

D. A new tree that has never grown pears

47. Read the passage: **The Wind Chimes**

Whenever the wind blew, the chimes outside Auntie's window made a soft, uneven song. After a storm, one metal tube was missing, and the sound seemed incomplete. Rather than replacing the whole set, Auntie asked her nephew to help make a new tube from an old piece of metal. Its note was slightly lower than the original, but together the chimes made a new melody.

Question: What changes after the storm?

A. One tube is missing from the wind chimes

B. The wind stops blowing permanently

C. The chimes are sold to a neighbor

D. The window is replaced with a door

48. Read the passage: **The Debate Team**

The debate team prepared arguments for whether the school should extend recess. When the opposing team raised a concern about losing lesson time, Amira did not dismiss it. She acknowledged the concern and explained that a slightly shorter transition between classes could make room for more outdoor time. Her coach praised her for answering the actual argument rather than repeating her own points.

Question: What concern does the opposing team raise?

A. Students do not like going outdoors

B. Longer recess could reduce lesson time

C. The school has no classrooms

D. Teachers want recess to last all day

49. Read the passage: **The River Stone**

A smooth gray stone sat on the classroom windowsill. It had come from a river near the town where the teacher grew up. When students asked why it was there, she explained that water had worn its rough edges over many years. She compared the stone to learning: repeated practice can shape a skill gradually, even when each small change is hard to notice.

Question: Where did the stone come from?

A. A quarry beside the school

B. The playground sandbox

C. A shop that sells classroom supplies

D. A river near the teacher’s childhood town

50. Read the passage: **The Costume Box**

The drama club’s costume box contained a cape, a hat, and a pair of oversized boots. When the lead actor lost his voice, the club worried that the performance would be canceled. The director gave a smaller role to a student who could speak the narrator’s lines, while the lead actor used gestures to act out the scene. The audience followed the story and applauded the teamwork.

Question: What problem threatens the performance?

A. The costume box is locked away

B. The lead actor loses his voice

C. The audience arrives too early

D. The narrator forgets to buy boots

Medium Questions (50)

1. Read the passage: **The Lantern**

Mara carried the old lantern up the hill, although the moon lit most of the path. At the summit, she found her grandfather waiting beside a broken fence. He smiled when he saw the lantern. “You remembered,” he said. Mara had almost stayed home because the lantern seemed unnecessary, but now she understood why he had asked her to bring it: its warm glow made the hidden gate visible.

Question: What does Mara understand at the end?

A. Her grandfather dislikes walking at night

B. The hill is too steep to climb safely

C. The lantern helps reveal something hard to see

D. The gate was never meant to be opened

2. Read the passage: **A Seat by the Window**

Every morning, Luis chose the seat by the library window. He liked watching the school garden change through the seasons. In September, tiny green shoots appeared; by December, frost covered the soil. One rainy day, he noticed a student sitting alone with a book held over her face. Luis moved his backpack and invited her to sit beside him. The garden could wait; someone needed company.

Question: Why does Luis invite the student to sit with him?

A. He wants her to move away from the window

B. He thinks she has taken his usual seat

C. He needs her to explain the garden project

D. He notices she is alone and may want company

3. Read the passage: **The Last Kite**

Nia’s kite had a blue tail and a patch shaped like a star. When a gust tore the string from her hand, it sailed over the fence into Mr. Bell’s orchard. Nia expected him to scold her, because he guarded his trees carefully. Instead, he brought out a long pole and helped retrieve it. “Fruit trees need care,” he said, “but so do people’s hopes.” Nia thanked him and promised to keep her kite away from the branches.

Question: What can the reader infer about Mr. Bell?

A. He cares only about protecting his fruit

B. He wants Nia to stop flying kites forever

C. He is more understanding than Nia expected

D. He dislikes helping children with problems

4. Read the passage: **The New Part**

During rehearsal, Theo missed the same line three times. Each time, he glanced at the audience seats and imagined everyone laughing. His friend Amira suggested that he mark the line in bright pencil and practice it while walking around the empty stage. After several tries, the words came naturally. On opening night, Theo still felt nervous, but he no longer feared the line.

Question: Which action helps Theo improve?

A. He waits until opening night to rehearse

B. He marks the line and practices it repeatedly

C. He removes the line from the script

D. He asks the audience to leave the room

5. Read the passage: **The Map in the Attic**

While helping clean the attic, Suri found a map tucked inside a cookbook. It showed the town square, the old bridge, and a small drawing of a bell near the river. Her aunt recognized the handwriting as her great-grandmother's. Together they followed the map and discovered a bronze bell stored in the historical society. A note explained that it had once rung to announce the start of the town fair.

Question: Why is the aunt's recognition important?

A. It proves the map was drawn yesterday

B. It shows the bell belongs to the school

C. It connects the map to Suri's family history

D. It explains why the town fair was canceled

6. Read the passage: **The Quiet Contest**

The science fair rewarded the loudest demonstrations with crowds, but Priya's project made almost no sound. She had built a simple filter that cleaned muddy water using sand, gravel, and charcoal. One judge watched her pour the same water through the filter twice. The second sample was clearer. Priya did not win the largest display prize, but she earned the award for practical design.

Question: Which evidence shows that Priya's filter works?

A. The project uses sand and gravel

B. The second water sample is clearer

C. Priya does not win the largest display prize

D. The crowd gathers around loud displays

7. Read the passage: **The Borrowed Book**

Owen borrowed a book of myths from the classroom shelf and promised to return it on Friday. On Thursday, he found that a page had come loose. He could have placed it back without telling anyone, but he took the book to Ms. Chen and explained what happened. She thanked him for being honest and showed him how to repair the page with archival tape.

Question: How does Ms. Chen respond to Owen?

A. She tells him to hide the loose page

B. She removes every myth book from the shelf

C. She asks him to buy a replacement immediately

D. She thanks him and helps repair the book

8. Read the passage: **A Different Route**

The bus usually took the main road to school, but construction blocked the bridge one Tuesday. At first, the passengers groaned as the driver turned onto a narrow street. Then they passed a bakery where warm rolls filled the air with a sweet smell and a mural showing the town's history. By the time they reached school, several students were discussing the things they had never noticed before.

Question: How do the passengers' feelings change?

A. They move from annoyance to interest

B. They stop noticing anything outside

C. They become more worried about being lost

D. They decide they do not want to attend school

9. Read the passage: **The Paper Bridge**

For the engineering challenge, each team had to build a bridge from paper and tape. Malik folded his sheets into narrow beams, while Zoe rolled hers into tubes. Their first bridge sagged under three books. Instead of arguing about whose idea had failed, they combined the beams and tubes. The new bridge held six books before bending. They wrote down the result, including what still needed improvement.

Question: Why do Malik and Zoe combine their designs?

A. They are told to copy another team’s bridge

B. They want to finish without testing anything

C. They disagree about how many books to use

D. They decide to build on both ideas after the first attempt

10. Read the passage: **The Old Oak**

A sign announced that the old oak beside the playground would be removed because its largest branch was damaged. Students gathered around it after lunch. Their teacher asked them to measure its trunk, sketch its shape, and write memories connected to the tree. On Friday, the class planted two young oaks in another part of the schoolyard. The old tree was gone, but its story became part of the school’s history.

Question: Why does the teacher ask students to record measurements and memories?

A. To decide which student owns the playground

B. To preserve information about the tree before it is gone

C. To prove the tree was taller than the school

D. To show that young trees grow faster in winter

11. Read the passage: **The Midnight Visitor**

A scratching sound woke Elena just after midnight. She crept downstairs and saw a shadow move across the kitchen wall. Her heart raced until she switched on the light. A small hedgehog stood beside the open back door, its nose twitching. Elena placed a laundry basket over it gently and called the wildlife rescue number printed on the fridge.

Question: What changes Elena’s understanding of the shadow?

A. The scratching stops before she arrives

B. The kitchen wall suddenly disappears

C. Turning on the light reveals a hedgehog

D. A neighbor explains the sound by phone

12. Read the passage: **The Promise**

Before moving away, Ben promised his neighbor Mrs. Ortiz that he would send a postcard from every place he visited. His first card showed a mountain. The second showed a crowded city. Months passed before the third arrived, showing only a small beach near his new home. Mrs. Ortiz placed all three cards on her mantel and smiled; the promise had kept their friendship alive across the distance.

Question: Why does Mrs. Ortiz display the postcards?

A. She needs to cover a stain on the mantel

B. They remind her of their continuing friendship

C. She is preparing a lesson about geography

D. They show that she has traveled to each place

13. Read the passage: **The Snow Day**

When school closed because of snow, Amari planned to build the tallest snow fort on the block. His younger sister could not lift the heavy packed snow, so he made a smaller section she could shape herself. By afternoon, their fort was not the tallest, but it had a tunnel, a flag, and a place for both of them to sit. Their neighbors asked to join the game.

Question: Why is the fort not the tallest?

A. The family runs out of time before starting

B. Amari adjusts the design so his sister can participate

C. The neighbors take away its snow

D. The snow is too deep to pack together

14. Read the passage: **The Song Collector**

Mr. Ade kept a notebook of songs sung at family celebrations. Some were lively songs everyone knew; others were short verses remembered only by his grandmother. When she could no longer sing for long, he recorded her humming and wrote down the words she remembered. Years later, his grandchildren used the notebook to teach the songs at a family gathering.

Question: Why does he record his grandmother humming?

A. He needs to prove that she remembers every word

B. He wants to preserve songs she may not be able to sing later

C. He plans to enter her in a singing contest

D. He wants to replace the notebook with a radio

15. Read the passage: **The Empty Frame**

A museum displayed an empty frame with a label explaining that the painting inside had been stolen decades earlier. Visitors often passed it without stopping. One day, a child asked why the museum did not simply replace the painting. The guide explained that the empty space reminded people of the loss and of the work still being done to recover stolen art. The child looked again and read the label carefully.

Question: What does the child’s question reveal?

A. The child has already seen the stolen painting

B. The reason for the empty frame is not immediately obvious

C. The child believes all art should be sold

D. The child works at the museum every weekend

16. Read the passage: **The Race at River Park**

Tessa trained for the river park race each morning, but on race day she noticed a younger runner sitting beside the course with a twisted ankle. She called for an adult and stayed until help arrived. By then, the leading runners had passed. Tessa finished far behind her personal goal, yet the race organizer thanked her publicly for acting quickly and responsibly.

Question: What does Tessa’s choice reveal about her priorities?

A. She cares more about public praise than training

B. She wants the other runners to lose

C. She does not understand the race rules

D. She places another person’s safety above winning

17. Read the passage: **The Strange Footprints**

After a night of rain, footprints crossed the soft garden soil and ended beneath the shed. Noah guessed they belonged to a fox, but his sister measured the prints and noticed they were much smaller than a fox's. They found a trail of sunflower seeds leading to a hole in the shed wall. A family of mice had been visiting the bird feeder.

Question: How do the siblings solve the mystery?

A. They ask the birds to identify the visitor

B. They wait for a fox to arrive at noon

C. They rebuild the shed before looking closer

D. They compare print size and follow the seed trail

18. Read the passage: **The Borrowed Violin**

Asha's music teacher lent her a violin for the weekend concert. At home, Asha practiced slowly, stopping whenever a note sounded rough. Her brother suggested playing faster so the mistakes would be harder to hear. Asha shook her head and repeated the difficult measures until each note was clear. At the concert, her hands trembled at first, then settled into the music.

Question: Why does Asha reject her brother's suggestion?

A. She plans to return the violin before the concert

B. She wants to improve the notes rather than hide mistakes

C. She does not want her brother to hear her play

D. She thinks fast music is never enjoyable

19. Read the passage: **The Garden Debate**

The class voted on what to plant in its garden. Most students wanted bright flowers, while Hana argued for vegetables. She brought a chart showing how much sunlight each plant needed and explained that the vegetables could be donated to the community kitchen. The class voted again and chose both vegetables and flowers, arranging them in separate beds.

Question: Which detail makes Hana's argument stronger?

A. She brings a chart about sunlight needs

B. The garden is located at school

C. Most students want bright flowers

D. The class has separate garden beds

20. Read the passage: **A Letter from the Past**

While sorting family papers, Darius found a letter written by his great-aunt when she was his age. She described walking several miles to school and sharing one classroom with children of different ages. Darius had complained that his school bus arrived too early. After reading the letter, he asked his great-aunt what she remembered most about school. Her answer began a conversation that lasted all afternoon.

Question: How does reading the letter affect Darius?

A. It leads him to ask questions about his great-aunt's past

B. It makes him throw away the family papers

C. It causes him to complain more about the bus

D. It convinces him to stop attending school

21. Read the passage: **The Windy Field**

The soccer team practiced in a field where the wind pushed every high pass sideways. The coach asked the players to keep the ball low and pass along the ground. At first, several players complained that the drill was boring. Soon they noticed that their passes became more accurate, even when the wind grew stronger. During the next match, they used the same strategy to keep possession.

Question: Why does the coach change the drill?

A. High passes are required in every match

B. Ground passes are less affected by the wind

C. The wind will stop if they wait long enough

D. The players want to practice running only

22. Read the passage: **The Cracked Bowl**

Grandma used a blue bowl with a thin crack along its rim. She never served soup in it anymore, but she filled it with orange marigolds and placed it on the kitchen table. When Eli offered to buy a new bowl, she laughed. “This one still has a job,” she said. Eli began noticing other repaired or reused objects around the house, each with its own story.

Question: What does Grandma mean by saying the bowl still has a job?

A. An object can have value even when used differently

B. Flowers grow better in cracked dishes than in soil

C. Every bowl must be used for serving soup

D. The bowl should be thrown away immediately

23. Read the passage: **The Secret Ingredient**

Mina followed her father’s recipe for vegetable stew, but the taste was flat. She checked the list twice and discovered she had skipped the lemon juice. After adding a small amount, she stirred and tasted again. The flavor brightened. Her father explained that the juice did not make the stew taste like lemons; it helped the other flavors stand out.

Question: What does the lemon juice do in the stew?

A. It changes the stew into a sweet dessert

B. It helps the other flavors stand out

C. It removes all the salt from the pot

D. It makes the vegetables cook instantly

24. Read the passage: **The Lighthouse Keeper**

During a storm, the lighthouse beam flickered twice. Keeper Rowan climbed the narrow stairs and found a loose connection in the lamp housing. The wind shook the windows, but he tightened the fitting and checked the light again. Far offshore, a fishing boat changed direction toward the safer channel. Rowan watched until the beam shone steadily across the water.

Question: Why is Rowan’s repair important?

A. It makes the storm end sooner

B. The steady beam helps guide a boat toward safety

C. It prevents the windows from shaking

D. It allows Rowan to leave the lighthouse immediately

25. Read the passage: **The Forgotten Lunch**

At noon, Sam opened his backpack and realized his lunch was still on the kitchen counter. He considered skipping lunch, but his classmate Noor offered to split her sandwich. Sam accepted half and promised to bring an extra snack the next day. When Noor forgot her water bottle later that week, Sam shared his spare bottle of water.

Question: What does Sam's later action show?

A. He expects Noor to bring lunch every day

B. He thinks water is more important than food

C. He no longer wants to share anything

D. He wants to return the kindness Noor showed him

26. Read the passage: **The Chalk Drawing**

A rainstorm washed away the chalk animals that Jo and her neighbors had drawn on the sidewalk. Jo felt disappointed, but her neighbor pointed out the bright colors spreading in the puddles. The next morning, they drew new animals with thicker outlines and added a little sign: "Temporary art—come make some." By afternoon, children from three streets had joined them.

Question: How does Jo respond to the problem?

A. She creates new drawings and invites others to join

B. She decides never to draw again

C. She paints permanent pictures on the sidewalk

D. She asks the rain to stop falling

27. Read the passage: **The Library Clock**

The clock above the library desk was five minutes fast. Most students did not notice, but Mr. Hale checked it against his watch every morning. When the clock stopped completely, the librarian asked students to estimate the time using the sunlit windows and the school bell schedule while maintenance came. Their guesses varied, so they learned why a reliable clock mattered.

Question: Why are the students' guesses different?

A. The sun never changes position

B. The school bell rings at random each day

C. Every student has the same broken watch

D. The clues they use do not give an exact shared time

28. Read the passage: **The Painted Bench**

The park bench had peeling green paint, so a group of volunteers offered to restore it. At first, they argued over whether to keep it green or choose a brighter color. An older resident explained that the bench had been green since the park opened. The volunteers kept the original color, sanded the wood, and added a small plaque thanking the people who had cared for the park.

Question: Why do they keep the bench green?

A. The brighter paint is impossible to buy

B. They discover that green paint dries instantly

C. They learn that the color is part of the park's history

D. The older resident orders them to stop working

29. Read the passage: **The Puzzle Tournament**

Leah solved the first puzzle quickly, then rushed through the second and missed an important clue. Her teammate reminded her that the team earned points only for correct solutions. Leah slowed down, reread the instructions, and found the hidden pattern. They finished with fewer attempted puzzles than some teams, but their answers were accurate.

Question: What advice does Leah's teammate give indirectly?

A. Every answer should be guessed immediately

B. Instructions should be ignored during contests

C. The team should stop attempting puzzles

D. Accuracy matters more than solving many puzzles quickly

30. Read the passage: **The Winter Birds**

When winter arrived, fewer birds visited the school garden. A group of students wanted to scatter bread crumbs, but their teacher helped them research suitable foods for local birds. They built a feeder and filled it with seeds recommended by a wildlife guide. Soon, small birds returned. The students recorded which species visited and changed the feeder's position to keep it away from prowling cats.

Question: What does the group do after birds return?

A. They replace seeds with bread every day

B. They stop checking the garden

C. They remove the feeder immediately

D. They record species and adjust the feeder's position

31. Read the passage: **The Train Window**

On the train, Ravi watched the city give way to fields, then to low hills. His grandmother told him that the route had once taken twice as long because the tracks curved around a marsh. Ravi asked why the railway had not simply crossed the marsh. She described the engineers' concern about soft ground and the damage construction might cause to the wetland.

Question: Why did the railway originally curve around the marsh?

A. The marsh was used as a train station

B. Engineers considered the soft ground and wetland damage

C. The tracks were built before trains existed

D. The city required all trains to avoid hills

32. Read the passage: **The First Snowflake**

Milo pressed his nose to the window and waited for the first snowflake. When one finally drifted down, he called his sister, who was busy finishing a drawing. By the time she arrived, the flake had melted on the sill. Milo apologized for interrupting her, but she laughed and pointed outside: hundreds of flakes were beginning to fall.

Question: Why has the first snowflake disappeared by the time she arrives?

A. The sister brushes it away

B. The wind blows it into the drawing

C. It melts on the windowsill

D. Milo carries it outside

33. Read the passage: **The Mystery of the Missing Pages**

The class novel seemed to jump from chapter four to chapter six. Instead of accusing the student who had borrowed it last, the class checked the reading corner, the teacher's desk, and the return basket. They found the missing pages folded inside a notebook used as a bookmark. The student who had borrowed the novel apologized for not noticing them.

Question: Why is it important that the class checks several places before accusing anyone?

A. They plan to remove the book from class

B. They want to avoid reading the novel

C. They seek evidence rather than blaming someone without proof

D. They know the student has hidden the pages

34. Read the passage: **The Shell Necklace**

At the shore, Amina collected shells for a necklace. Her cousin warned her not to take the striped shell from a tide pool because a tiny animal was tucked inside it. Amina returned the shell to the water and chose empty ones from the sand instead. The necklace looked different from the one she had imagined, but she liked knowing the tide-pool creature could remain safe.

Question: What does Amina's choice reveal about her?

A. She does not listen to her cousin

B. She wants to collect every shell at the shore

C. She is willing to change her plan to protect an animal

D. She cares only about making the necklace look perfect

35. Read the passage: **The School Newspaper**

Editors of the school newspaper disagreed about the headline for an article on cafeteria waste. One group wanted "Lunchroom Disaster," while another suggested "Students Find Ways to Waste Less." Their adviser asked which headline fairly represented the article, which described both the problem and a new composting plan. The editors chose a headline that informed readers without exaggerating.

Question: Why does the adviser ask whether the headline is fair?

A. Readers never look at headlines

B. A headline should represent the article accurately

C. The article contains no information about waste

D. Headlines should always sound dramatic

36. Read the passage: **The Stone in the Path**

A large stone blocked the path to the community garden. Several people stepped around it and continued on. Young Mateo fetched a sturdy board and asked two neighbors to help lever the stone aside. It took longer than expected, and they had to change their position twice. When the path was clear, an older gardener thanked them because her cart could now pass.

Question: Why does Mateo ask neighbors for help?

A. Moving the stone requires more effort than one person can manage easily

B. The board is too small to carry

C. He does not know where the garden is

D. He wants them to block the path again

37. Read the passage: **The Unfinished Song**

Mira's mother used to sing a lullaby that ended with a line Mira could never remember. After her mother moved overseas for work, Mira asked relatives if they knew the missing words. Each remembered a slightly different ending. Mira sent the versions to her mother, who replied with a voice message singing the line exactly as she had learned it from her own mother.

Question: Why do the relatives remember different endings?

A. Mira changes the words before asking them

B. The song has been passed along through memory

C. They are reading from the same printed book

D. The lullaby was written only last week

38. Read the passage: **The Two Invitations**

On the same Saturday, Kai received invitations to a robotics workshop and his cousin's birthday picnic. He wanted to attend both, but the times overlapped. After checking the workshop schedule, he learned that the final hour would be repeated the following week. He went to the picnic and arranged to attend the repeated workshop session later.

Question: What information helps Kai make a plan?

A. The picnic will be moved indoors

B. His cousin has already left town

C. The workshop will repeat its final hour the next week

D. The robotics team has no equipment

39. Read the passage: **The Glass Jar**

Every time the family visited the beach, they placed one smooth pebble in a glass jar. At first, the jar held only a few stones. Years later, it was nearly full. When the youngest child asked which pebble was the most important, her father said that no single one mattered most; together, they showed how many days the family had spent exploring.

Question: What does the nearly full jar represent?

A. The youngest child's interest in glassmaking

B. The number of pebbles found in one afternoon

C. The many beach visits shared by the family

D. The father's plan to sell the stones

40. Read the passage: **The Brave Apology**

During group work, Felix told the class that his teammate had lost their notes. Later, he discovered that he had left the notes in his own locker. He thought about staying quiet because no one had challenged him. Instead, he explained the mistake to the group and apologized. His teammate accepted the apology, and they recreated the notes together.

Question: Why might apologizing be difficult for Felix?

A. He knows his teammate has hidden the notes

B. He has never met his teammate before

C. He must admit that his earlier accusation was wrong

D. He wants the group to stop working

41. Read the passage: **The Night Train**

The train rattled through the dark countryside while Imani read the same paragraph three times. Across the aisle, a little boy pressed his forehead to the glass and counted the lights of distant houses. His mother whispered that each light belonged to someone ending a day. Imani lowered her book and began to watch the scattered windows too, imagining the lives behind them.

Question: What changes Imani's attention?

A. A conductor asks her to close the book

B. The train stops at a busy station

C. The mother's comment about the distant lights

D. The boy takes her book from the seat

42. Read the passage: **The Rain Barrel**

The school garden often needed water during dry weeks. After a lesson about conservation, the class placed a rain barrel beneath a roof drain. The first storm filled it almost to the top. When the next dry spell came, students used the stored water on their plants. They made a chart comparing how much tap water they used before and after the barrel was installed.

Question: Why does the class make a chart?

A. To measure how much sunlight reaches the roof

B. To compare tap-water use before and after the change

C. To list every student who likes gardening

D. To predict the exact date of the next storm

43. Read the passage: **The Marble Champion**

At recess, everyone wanted to challenge Sefa, the best marble player in class. When a new student lost every round, Sefa noticed that he kept aiming too high. Rather than taking another turn, Sefa showed him how to steady his thumb and aim at the ground near the target. The next day, the new student won a round and grinned at Sefa across the playground.

Question: What changes after Sefa gives advice?

A. The class stops playing at recess

B. Sefa loses every marble he owns

C. The new student refuses to try again

D. The new student wins a round the next day

44. Read the passage: **The Museum of Small Things**

For a class exhibition, each student brought an ordinary object with a story. Lila chose a bent spoon from her family's camping box. It had been used to stir soup during a stormy night when her family's tent leaked and everyone huddled under a tarp. Visitors first laughed at the spoon's shape, then listened closely as Lila described the night it reminded her of.

Question: How do visitors respond as Lila explains the story?

A. They decide that every object must be new

B. They demand that she replace the spoon

C. They leave the exhibition immediately

D. They become more interested and listen closely

45. Read the passage: **The Lost Dog Poster**

After a dog disappeared from the neighborhood, the children made posters with a clear photograph, the dog's name, and a phone number. One child wanted to add a long description of the dog's favorite games, but the group kept the poster brief so people could read it while walking past. Two days later, a shopkeeper called the number after spotting the dog near the market.

Question: Which information proves most useful for contacting the owner?

A. The description of the dog's favorite games

B. The children's names at the bottom

C. The date the paper was purchased

D. The phone number printed on the poster

46. Read the passage: **The Orchard Path**

Grandfather walked slowly along the orchard path, stopping at trees he had planted as a young man. He showed Niko a pear tree with a split trunk that still produced fruit. "A storm damaged it," he said, "but we supported the branch and gave it time." Niko had been frustrated about a failed school project. On the walk home, he decided to revise his plan instead of abandoning it.

Question: How does the tree influence Niko?

A. It encourages him to revise rather than give up

B. It teaches him to avoid asking for help

C. It makes him blame the weather for his work

D. It convinces him to stop doing school projects

47. Read the passage: **The Wind Chimes**

Whenever the wind blew, the chimes outside Auntie's window made a soft, uneven song. After a storm, one metal tube was missing, and the sound seemed incomplete. Rather than replacing the whole set, Auntie asked her nephew to help make a new tube from an old piece of metal. Its note was slightly lower than the original, but together the chimes made a new melody.

Question: Why does Auntie make one new tube instead of replacing the set?

A. She wants the chimes to stop making sound

B. She can repair what is damaged and keep the rest

C. She has lost every other tube

D. She believes old objects cannot be repaired

48. Read the passage: **The Debate Team**

The debate team prepared arguments for whether the school should extend recess. When the opposing team raised a concern about losing lesson time, Amira did not dismiss it. She acknowledged the concern and explained that a slightly shorter transition between classes could make room for more outdoor time. Her coach praised her for answering the actual argument rather than repeating her own points.

Question: Why does Amira acknowledge the opposing argument?

A. She agrees that recess should be removed

B. She wants to respond to the concern fairly and directly

C. She has forgotten her own position

D. She hopes the debate will end without a decision

49. Read the passage: **The River Stone**

A smooth gray stone sat on the classroom windowsill. It had come from a river near the town where the teacher grew up. When students asked why it was there, she explained that water had worn its rough edges over many years. She compared the stone to learning: repeated practice can shape a skill gradually, even when each small change is hard to notice.

Question: How did the stone become smooth?

A. Water gradually wore away its rough edges

B. It was made smooth before entering the river

C. Students rubbed it during every lesson

D. The teacher polished it every morning

50. Read the passage: **The Costume Box**

The drama club's costume box contained a cape, a hat, and a pair of oversized boots. When the lead actor lost his voice, the club worried that the performance would be canceled. The director gave a smaller role to a student who could speak the narrator's lines, while the lead actor used gestures to act out the scene. The audience followed the story and applauded the teamwork.

Question: How does the director solve the problem?

A. She cancels the performance without trying

B. She asks the audience to read the script

C. She removes every character from the scene

D. She rearranges the roles so the show can continue

Hard Questions (50)

1. Read the passage: **The Lantern**

Mara carried the old lantern up the hill, although the moon lit most of the path. At the summit, she found her grandfather waiting beside a broken fence. He smiled when he saw the lantern. “You remembered,” he said. Mara had almost stayed home because the lantern seemed unnecessary, but now she understood why he had asked her to bring it: its warm glow made the hidden gate visible.

Question: Which detail best supports the idea that the lantern was useful?

A. Its glow made the hidden gate visible

B. The moon lit most of the path

C. Mara almost stayed home

D. Her grandfather stood by a fence

2. Read the passage: **A Seat by the Window**

Every morning, Luis chose the seat by the library window. He liked watching the school garden change through the seasons. In September, tiny green shoots appeared; by December, frost covered the soil. One rainy day, he noticed a student sitting alone with a book held over her face. Luis moved his backpack and invited her to sit beside him. The garden could wait; someone needed company.

Question: What does the final sentence suggest about Luis?

A. He values kindness more than his usual routine

B. He prefers working outside to being in the library

C. He no longer enjoys watching the garden

D. He believes books should not be read in rain

3. Read the passage: **The Last Kite**

Nia’s kite had a blue tail and a patch shaped like a star. When a gust tore the string from her hand, it sailed over the fence into Mr. Bell’s orchard. Nia expected him to scold her, because he guarded his trees carefully. Instead, he brought out a long pole and helped retrieve it. “Fruit trees need care,” he said, “but so do people’s hopes.” Nia thanked him and promised to keep her kite away from the branches.

Question: What is the most likely meaning of Mr. Bell’s final statement?

A. Kites should never be flown near houses

B. People’s feelings and goals deserve care too

C. Fruit trees grow best when children help

D. Hope is something that can be planted in soil

4. Read the passage: **The New Part**

During rehearsal, Theo missed the same line three times. Each time, he glanced at the audience seats and imagined everyone laughing. His friend Amira suggested that he mark the line in bright pencil and practice it while walking around the empty stage. After several tries, the words came naturally. On opening night, Theo still felt nervous, but he no longer feared the line.

Question: How does Theo change by the end?

A. He becomes more confident about saying the line

B. He learns to avoid speaking in public

C. He stops feeling any nervousness at all

D. He decides that acting is not for him

5. Read the passage: **The Map in the Attic**

While helping clean the attic, Suri found a map tucked inside a cookbook. It showed the town square, the old bridge, and a small drawing of a bell near the river. Her aunt recognized the handwriting as her great-grandmother's. Together they followed the map and discovered a bronze bell stored in the historical society. A note explained that it had once rung to announce the start of the town fair.

Question: What is the central idea of the passage?

A. Cleaning an attic is usually a difficult task

B. Old objects should be kept away from museums

C. A map is useful only when it shows roads

D. A family discovery reveals a piece of local history

6. Read the passage: **The Quiet Contest**

The science fair rewarded the loudest demonstrations with crowds, but Priya's project made almost no sound. She had built a simple filter that cleaned muddy water using sand, gravel, and charcoal. One judge watched her pour the same water through the filter twice. The second sample was clearer. Priya did not win the largest display prize, but she earned the award for practical design.

Question: What lesson is suggested by Priya's result?

A. Judges prefer projects that use expensive materials

B. Quiet projects should be presented after every other project

C. Winning depends mainly on having the biggest display

D. Useful work can matter even without attracting attention

7. Read the passage: **The Borrowed Book**

Owen borrowed a book of myths from the classroom shelf and promised to return it on Friday. On Thursday, he found that a page had come loose. He could have placed it back without telling anyone, but he took the book to Ms. Chen and explained what happened. She thanked him for being honest and showed him how to repair the page with archival tape.

Question: Which trait does Owen show most clearly?

A. Jealousy

B. Honesty

C. Impatience

D. Carelessness

8. Read the passage: **A Different Route**

The bus usually took the main road to school, but construction blocked the bridge one Tuesday. At first, the passengers groaned as the driver turned onto a narrow street. Then they passed a bakery where warm rolls filled the air with a sweet smell and a mural showing the town's history. By the time they reached school, several students were discussing the things they had never noticed before.

Question: What does the mural contribute to the story?

A. It proves the bakery is the oldest in town

B. It shows why the bridge was closed

C. It gives passengers something new to notice and discuss

D. It explains how the bus engine works

9. Read the passage: **The Paper Bridge**

For the engineering challenge, each team had to build a bridge from paper and tape. Malik folded his sheets into narrow beams, while Zoe rolled hers into tubes. Their first bridge sagged under three books. Instead of arguing about whose idea had failed, they combined the beams and tubes. The new bridge held six books before bending. They wrote down the result, including what still needed improvement.

Question: What does recording what still needs improvement show?

A. They are using the test to guide further learning

B. They believe their bridge cannot be improved

C. They are trying to avoid explaining their results

D. They think the challenge is about writing neatly

10. Read the passage: **The Old Oak**

A sign announced that the old oak beside the playground would be removed because its largest branch was damaged. Students gathered around it after lunch. Their teacher asked them to measure its trunk, sketch its shape, and write memories connected to the tree. On Friday, the class planted two young oaks in another part of the schoolyard. The old tree was gone, but its story became part of the school's history.

Question: What does planting two young oaks suggest?

A. The teacher believes trees should never be measured

B. The class wants to continue the tree's legacy

C. The school will remove every older plant

D. The students have forgotten the old tree

11. Read the passage: **The Midnight Visitor**

A scratching sound woke Elena just after midnight. She crept downstairs and saw a shadow move across the kitchen wall. Her heart raced until she switched on the light. A small hedgehog stood beside the open back door, its nose twitching. Elena placed a laundry basket over it gently and called the wildlife rescue number printed on the fridge.

Question: Which word best describes Elena's response after discovering the animal?

A. Uninterested

B. Careful

C. Reckless

D. Angry

12. Read the passage: **The Promise**

Before moving away, Ben promised his neighbor Mrs. Ortiz that he would send a postcard from every place he visited. His first card showed a mountain. The second showed a crowded city. Months passed before the third arrived, showing only a small beach near his new home. Mrs. Ortiz placed all three cards on her mantel and smiled; the promise had kept their friendship alive across the distance.

Question: What is the passage's message?

A. Moving away always ends a friendship

B. Postcards are better than every other kind of message

C. Small acts can help maintain relationships over time

D. People should only make promises they can finish quickly

13. Read the passage: **The Snow Day**

When school closed because of snow, Amari planned to build the tallest snow fort on the block. His younger sister could not lift the heavy packed snow, so he made a smaller section she could shape herself. By afternoon, their fort was not the tallest, but it had a tunnel, a flag, and a place for both of them to sit. Their neighbors asked to join the game.

Question: Which idea is best supported by the ending?

A. Including others can make an activity more rewarding

B. Younger children should not help with building

C. A contest is worthwhile only when someone wins

D. The biggest structure is always the best one

14. Read the passage: **The Song Collector**

Mr. Ade kept a notebook of songs sung at family celebrations. Some were lively songs everyone knew; others were short verses remembered only by his grandmother. When she could no longer sing for long, he recorded her humming and wrote down the words she remembered. Years later, his grandchildren used the notebook to teach the songs at a family gathering.

Question: How does the notebook affect later generations?

A. It prevents the family from holding gatherings

B. It teaches the grandchildren to avoid old traditions

C. It changes the songs into written stories

D. It helps grandchildren learn and share family songs

15. Read the passage: **The Empty Frame**

A museum displayed an empty frame with a label explaining that the painting inside had been stolen decades earlier. Visitors often passed it without stopping. One day, a child asked why the museum did not simply replace the painting. The guide explained that the empty space reminded people of the loss and of the work still being done to recover stolen art. The child looked again and read the label carefully.

Question: How does the child respond to the guide’s explanation?

A. The child decides the museum should close

B. The child asks to remove the frame

C. The child leaves before hearing the answer

D. The child gives the label more careful attention

16. Read the passage: **The Race at River Park**

Tessa trained for the river park race each morning, but on race day she noticed a younger runner sitting beside the course with a twisted ankle. She called for an adult and stayed until help arrived. By then, the leading runners had passed. Tessa finished far behind her personal goal, yet the race organizer thanked her publicly for acting quickly and responsibly.

Question: Which statement best expresses a theme?

A. Training is useless when a course is crowded

B. Doing the right thing may matter more than reaching a personal goal

C. Every race should have the same winner

D. People should avoid helping strangers during events

17. Read the passage: **The Strange Footprints**

After a night of rain, footprints crossed the soft garden soil and ended beneath the shed. Noah guessed they belonged to a fox, but his sister measured the prints and noticed they were much smaller than a fox's. They found a trail of sunflower seeds leading to a hole in the shed wall. A family of mice had been visiting the bird feeder.

Question: What does this passage show about making a conclusion?

A. A guess should be checked against evidence

B. Mysteries can only be solved by adults

C. Small clues are never useful

D. The first explanation is usually correct

18. Read the passage: **The Borrowed Violin**

Asha's music teacher lent her a violin for the weekend concert. At home, Asha practiced slowly, stopping whenever a note sounded rough. Her brother suggested playing faster so the mistakes would be harder to hear. Asha shook her head and repeated the difficult measures until each note was clear. At the concert, her hands trembled at first, then settled into the music.

Question: What does the ending suggest about Asha's nervousness?

A. It eases as she becomes focused on playing

B. It grows until she cannot continue

C. It disappears before she reaches the stage

D. It causes her to forget the music entirely

19. Read the passage: **The Garden Debate**

The class voted on what to plant in its garden. Most students wanted bright flowers, while Hana argued for vegetables. She brought a chart showing how much sunlight each plant needed and explained that the vegetables could be donated to the community kitchen. The class voted again and chose both vegetables and flowers, arranging them in separate beds.

Question: What does the final decision show?

A. The class abandons the garden project

B. The students choose plants without discussion

C. Hana refuses to listen to other students

D. The class finds a compromise between different preferences

20. Read the passage: **A Letter from the Past**

While sorting family papers, Darius found a letter written by his great-aunt when she was his age. She described walking several miles to school and sharing one classroom with children of different ages. Darius had complained that his school bus arrived too early. After reading the letter, he asked his great-aunt what she remembered most about school. Her answer began a conversation that lasted all afternoon.

Question: What is a likely theme?

A. Children should never question older relatives

B. Letters are less meaningful than photographs

C. Learning about the past can deepen family connections

D. All generations have exactly the same school experiences

21. Read the passage: **The Windy Field**

The soccer team practiced in a field where the wind pushed every high pass sideways. The coach asked the players to keep the ball low and pass along the ground. At first, several players complained that the drill was boring. Soon they noticed that their passes became more accurate, even when the wind grew stronger. During the next match, they used the same strategy to keep possession.

Question: How does the team use what it learns?

A. It replaces soccer with a different sport

B. It asks the referee to change the weather

C. It refuses to play when the wind blows

D. It applies the ground-pass strategy during a match

22. Read the passage: **The Cracked Bowl**

Grandma used a blue bowl with a thin crack along its rim. She never served soup in it anymore, but she filled it with orange marigolds and placed it on the kitchen table. When Eli offered to buy a new bowl, she laughed. “This one still has a job,” she said. Eli began noticing other repaired or reused objects around the house, each with its own story.

Question: What does Eli begin to notice?

A. The house contains no new objects

B. Reused objects can carry stories and purpose

C. Every repaired object is broken beyond use

D. His grandmother dislikes buying anything

23. Read the passage: **The Secret Ingredient**

Mina followed her father’s recipe for vegetable stew, but the taste was flat. She checked the list twice and discovered she had skipped the lemon juice. After adding a small amount, she stirred and tasted again. The flavor brightened. Her father explained that the juice did not make the stew taste like lemons; it helped the other flavors stand out.

Question: Which broader idea is illustrated by the cooking lesson?

A. The strongest flavor is always the best

B. Cooking is successful only when done alone

C. Recipes should never be followed carefully

D. A small change can improve a larger result

24. Read the passage: **The Lighthouse Keeper**

During a storm, the lighthouse beam flickered twice. Keeper Rowan climbed the narrow stairs and found a loose connection in the lamp housing. The wind shook the windows, but he tightened the fitting and checked the light again. Far offshore, a fishing boat changed direction toward the safer channel. Rowan watched until the beam shone steadily across the water.

Question: What does Rowan’s behavior suggest?

A. He is responsible and persistent under pressure

B. He cares more about the storm than the boat

C. He is surprised that lighthouses use lights

D. He avoids difficult work whenever possible

25. Read the passage: **The Forgotten Lunch**

At noon, Sam opened his backpack and realized his lunch was still on the kitchen counter. He considered skipping lunch, but his classmate Noor offered to split her sandwich. Sam accepted half and promised to bring an extra snack the next day. When Noor forgot her water bottle later that week, Sam shared his spare bottle of water.

Question: Which statement best summarizes the passage?

A. A student learns to cook a sandwich at school

B. Two friends compete to bring the biggest lunch

C. A class decides to change its lunch schedule

D. Two classmates help each other when one is unprepared

26. Read the passage: **The Chalk Drawing**

A rainstorm washed away the chalk animals that Jo and her neighbors had drawn on the sidewalk. Jo felt disappointed, but her neighbor pointed out the bright colors spreading in the puddles. The next morning, they drew new animals with thicker outlines and added a little sign: “Temporary art—come make some.” By afternoon, children from three streets had joined them.

Question: What does the sign contribute to the story?

A. It turns a personal activity into a shared community event

B. It tells children that art must last forever

C. It explains why chalk cannot be used outdoors

D. It warns people to stay away from the sidewalk

27. Read the passage: **The Library Clock**

The clock above the library desk was five minutes fast. Most students did not notice, but Mr. Hale checked it against his watch every morning. When the clock stopped completely, the librarian asked students to estimate the time using the sunlit windows and the school bell schedule while maintenance came. Their guesses varied, so they learned why a reliable clock mattered.

Question: What is the passage mainly about?

A. A librarian teaches students how to build a window

B. Students compete to see who can guess the time fastest

C. A small problem helps students understand the value of accurate timekeeping

D. A clock is more useful than every school rule

28. Read the passage: **The Painted Bench**

The park bench had peeling green paint, so a group of volunteers offered to restore it. At first, they argued over whether to keep it green or choose a brighter color. An older resident explained that the bench had been green since the park opened. The volunteers kept the original color, sanded the wood, and added a small plaque thanking the people who had cared for the park.

Question: What does the plaque add to the project?

A. It recognizes the community’s care for the park

B. It announces that the park will close

C. It lists the names of every visitor

D. It explains how to build a wooden bench

29. Read the passage: **The Puzzle Tournament**

Leah solved the first puzzle quickly, then rushed through the second and missed an important clue. Her teammate reminded her that the team earned points only for correct solutions. Leah slowed down, reread the instructions, and found the hidden pattern. They finished with fewer attempted puzzles than some teams, but their answers were accurate.

Question: How does Leah change her approach?

A. She slows down and rereads the instructions

B. She solves the puzzles without looking at clues

C. She leaves the tournament before finishing

D. She asks another team to give her answers

30. Read the passage: **The Winter Birds**

When winter arrived, fewer birds visited the school garden. A group of students wanted to scatter bread crumbs, but their teacher helped them research suitable foods for local birds. They built a feeder and filled it with seeds recommended by a wildlife guide. Soon, small birds returned. The students recorded which species visited and changed the feeder's position to keep it away from prowling cats.

Question: Which theme is best supported?

A. Careful research can help people care for living things

B. Winter makes every outdoor project impossible

C. Wildlife should never be observed by students

D. All birds prefer the same food

31. Read the passage: **The Train Window**

On the train, Ravi watched the city give way to fields, then to low hills. His grandmother told him that the route had once taken twice as long because the tracks curved around a marsh. Ravi asked why the railway had not simply crossed the marsh. She described the engineers' concern about soft ground and the damage construction might cause to the wetland.

Question: What does the grandmother's explanation help Ravi understand?

A. Trains cannot travel through cities

B. Wetlands are always easy to build across

C. Railway routes are chosen only for speed

D. Engineering decisions can involve environmental concerns

32. Read the passage: **The First Snowflake**

Milo pressed his nose to the window and waited for the first snowflake. When one finally drifted down, he called his sister, who was busy finishing a drawing. By the time she arrived, the flake had melted on the sill. Milo apologized for interrupting her, but she laughed and pointed outside: hundreds of flakes were beginning to fall.

Question: How does the ending change the mood?

A. It changes from excitement to fear of winter

B. It suggests the snow will never return

C. It shifts from a missed moment to shared excitement

D. It makes the characters angry with each other

33. Read the passage: **The Mystery of the Missing Pages**

The class novel seemed to jump from chapter four to chapter six. Instead of accusing the student who had borrowed it last, the class checked the reading corner, the teacher’s desk, and the return basket. They found the missing pages folded inside a notebook used as a bookmark. The student who had borrowed the novel apologized for not noticing them.

Question: How is the problem resolved?

A. The pages are found inside a notebook

B. The class writes a new chapter six

C. The student buys a different novel

D. The teacher changes the reading assignment

34. Read the passage: **The Shell Necklace**

At the shore, Amina collected shells for a necklace. Her cousin warned her not to take the striped shell from a tide pool because a tiny animal was tucked inside it. Amina returned the shell to the water and chose empty ones from the sand instead. The necklace looked different from the one she had imagined, but she liked knowing the tide-pool creature could remain safe.

Question: What is the main lesson of the passage?

A. Every collection must match an original plan

B. Tide pools are not places for small animals

C. Enjoying nature can include leaving living things undisturbed

D. A necklace is valuable only when it uses rare shells

35. Read the passage: **The School Newspaper**

Editors of the school newspaper disagreed about the headline for an article on cafeteria waste. One group wanted “Lunchroom Disaster,” while another suggested “Students Find Ways to Waste Less.” Their adviser asked which headline fairly represented the article, which described both the problem and a new composting plan. The editors chose a headline that informed readers without exaggerating.

Question: Which principle do the editors follow in the end?

A. Inform readers without exaggerating the facts

B. Choose the most shocking words available

C. Hide the problem from the school community

D. Write a headline unrelated to the article

36. Read the passage: **The Stone in the Path**

A large stone blocked the path to the community garden. Several people stepped around it and continued on. Young Mateo fetched a sturdy board and asked two neighbors to help lever the stone aside. It took longer than expected, and they had to change their position twice. When the path was clear, an older gardener thanked them because her cart could now pass.

Question: What is the result of their work?

A. The neighbors decide to stop helping

B. The stone becomes part of a new wall

C. The garden is moved to another street

D. The path becomes usable for the gardener’s cart

37. Read the passage: **The Unfinished Song**

Mira's mother used to sing a lullaby that ended with a line Mira could never remember. After her mother moved overseas for work, Mira asked relatives if they knew the missing words. Each remembered a slightly different ending. Mira sent the versions to her mother, who replied with a voice message singing the line exactly as she had learned it from her own mother.

Question: What does the voice message add to the story?

A. It proves the relatives were trying to compete

B. It shows that Mira dislikes music

C. It connects the lullaby across generations

D. It replaces the need to remember family traditions

38. Read the passage: **The Two Invitations**

On the same Saturday, Kai received invitations to a robotics workshop and his cousin's birthday picnic. He wanted to attend both, but the times overlapped. After checking the workshop schedule, he learned that the final hour would be repeated the following week. He went to the picnic and arranged to attend the repeated workshop session later.

Question: What does Kai's solution show?

A. He gives up both activities immediately

B. He chooses an event without considering the times

C. He expects everyone else to change plans

D. He checks details and looks for a practical compromise

39. Read the passage: **The Glass Jar**

Every time the family visited the beach, they placed one smooth pebble in a glass jar. At first, the jar held only a few stones. Years later, it was nearly full. When the youngest child asked which pebble was the most important, her father said that no single one mattered most; together, they showed how many days the family had spent exploring.

Question: What is the father's point about the pebbles?

A. Only the oldest pebble has value

B. The jar should be emptied after every trip

C. The family should stop visiting the beach

D. Their combined meaning matters more than one individual stone

40. Read the passage: **The Brave Apology**

During group work, Felix told the class that his teammate had lost their notes. Later, he discovered that he had left the notes in his own locker. He thought about staying quiet because no one had challenged him. Instead, he explained the mistake to the group and apologized. His teammate accepted the apology, and they recreated the notes together.

Question: How is the conflict resolved?

A. The teammate leaves without speaking

B. Felix apologizes and the group recreates the notes

C. The teacher removes Felix from the class

D. The group decides not to finish the work

41. Read the passage: **The Night Train**

The train rattled through the dark countryside while Imani read the same paragraph three times. Across the aisle, a little boy pressed his forehead to the glass and counted the lights of distant houses. His mother whispered that each light belonged to someone ending a day. Imani lowered her book and began to watch the scattered windows too, imagining the lives behind them.

Question: What does the image of lights in distant houses encourage Imani to do?

A. Count the pages remaining in her book

B. Plan to visit every house along the track

C. Guess how fast the train is moving

D. Imagine the unseen lives of other people

42. Read the passage: **The Rain Barrel**

The school garden often needed water during dry weeks. After a lesson about conservation, the class placed a rain barrel beneath a roof drain. The first storm filled it almost to the top. When the next dry spell came, students used the stored water on their plants. They made a chart comparing how much tap water they used before and after the barrel was installed.

Question: Which idea is best supported by the passage?

A. Gardens should only be watered during storms

B. Collecting rainwater can help conserve a resource

C. A rain barrel prevents all dry weather

D. Charts are useful only for recording plant heights

43. Read the passage: **The Marble Champion**

At recess, everyone wanted to challenge Sefa, the best marble player in class. When a new student lost every round, Sefa noticed that he kept aiming too high. Rather than taking another turn, Sefa showed him how to steady his thumb and aim at the ground near the target. The next day, the new student won a round and grinned at Sefa across the playground.

Question: Which trait does Sefa demonstrate?

A. Generosity

B. Impatience

C. Suspicion

D. Pride

44. Read the passage: **The Museum of Small Things**

For a class exhibition, each student brought an ordinary object with a story. Lila chose a bent spoon from her family's camping box. It had been used to stir soup during a stormy night when her family's tent leaked and everyone huddled under a tarp. Visitors first laughed at the spoon's shape, then listened closely as Lila described the night it reminded her of.

Question: What does the exhibition suggest about ordinary objects?

A. Their stories can give them personal meaning

B. They are valuable only when they look unusual

C. They should never be used after a trip

D. They are interesting only to collectors

45. Read the passage: **The Lost Dog Poster**

After a dog disappeared from the neighborhood, the children made posters with a clear photograph, the dog's name, and a phone number. One child wanted to add a long description of the dog's favorite games, but the group kept the poster brief so people could read it while walking past. Two days later, a shopkeeper called the number after spotting the dog near the market.

Question: What does the successful search show?

A. A missing pet should never be reported

B. Long descriptions always work better than short ones

C. Posters are useful only inside schools

D. Clear, focused information can help solve a problem

46. Read the passage: **The Orchard Path**

Grandfather walked slowly along the orchard path, stopping at trees he had planted as a young man. He showed Niko a pear tree with a split trunk that still produced fruit. "A storm damaged it," he said, "but we supported the branch and gave it time." Niko had been frustrated about a failed school project. On the walk home, he decided to revise his plan instead of abandoning it.

Question: What is the likely theme?

A. Old trees should always be cut down

B. School projects should never be changed

C. Setbacks can be overcome with care and persistence

D. Success comes only when plans work the first time

47. Read the passage: **The Wind Chimes**

Whenever the wind blew, the chimes outside Auntie's window made a soft, uneven song. After a storm, one metal tube was missing, and the sound seemed incomplete. Rather than replacing the whole set, Auntie asked her nephew to help make a new tube from an old piece of metal. Its note was slightly lower than the original, but together the chimes made a new melody.

Question: What does the new melody represent?

A. Storms always improve musical instruments

B. A solution can preserve the past while creating something different

C. New objects have no connection to old ones

D. Every repair must sound exactly as before

48. Read the passage: **The Debate Team**

The debate team prepared arguments for whether the school should extend recess. When the opposing team raised a concern about losing lesson time, Amira did not dismiss it. She acknowledged the concern and explained that a slightly shorter transition between classes could make room for more outdoor time. Her coach praised her for answering the actual argument rather than repeating her own points.

Question: What debate skill does Amira demonstrate?

A. Avoiding the other team's strongest point

B. Repeating the same claim without evidence

C. Responding to a counterargument with a relevant explanation

D. Changing the topic whenever challenged

49. Read the passage: **The River Stone**

A smooth gray stone sat on the classroom windowsill. It had come from a river near the town where the teacher grew up. When students asked why it was there, she explained that water had worn its rough edges over many years. She compared the stone to learning: repeated practice can shape a skill gradually, even when each small change is hard to notice.

Question: What comparison does the teacher make?

A. Practice can gradually shape a skill

B. Learning should happen without effort

C. Stones are more useful than books

D. Skills change only in one large step

50. Read the passage: **The Costume Box**

The drama club's costume box contained a cape, a hat, and a pair of oversized boots. When the lead actor lost his voice, the club worried that the performance would be canceled. The director gave a smaller role to a student who could speak the narrator's lines, while the lead actor used gestures to act out the scene. The audience followed the story and applauded the teamwork.

Question: What does the audience's response emphasize?

A. A performance needs expensive costumes

B. A story cannot be understood without every line spoken

C. Only lead actors deserve applause

D. Cooperation can help a group overcome a setback

Answer Key

Answers are listed by difficulty section and question number.

Easy

1. B 2. C 3. D 4. A 5. A 6. C 7. A 8. C 9. A 10. B

11. C 12. B 13. C 14. A 15. A 16. B 17. D 18. D 19. C 20. B

21. C 22. C 23. C 24. A 25. B 26. D 27. D 28. C 29. A 30. C

31. D 32. B 33. A 34. D 35. B 36. B 37. A 38. A 39. C 40. C

41. D 42. C 43. C 44. A 45. C 46. B 47. A 48. B 49. D 50. B

Medium

1. C 2. D 3. C 4. B 5. C 6. B 7. D 8. A 9. D 10. B

11. C 12. B 13. B 14. B 15. B 16. D 17. D 18. B 19. A 20. A

21. B 22. A 23. B 24. B 25. D 26. A 27. D 28. C 29. D 30. D

31. B 32. C 33. C 34. C 35. B 36. A 37. B 38. C 39. C 40. C

41. C 42. B 43. D 44. D 45. D 46. A 47. B 48. B 49. A 50. D

Hard

1. A 2. A 3. B 4. A 5. D 6. D 7. B 8. C 9. A 10. B

11. B 12. C 13. A 14. D 15. D 16. B 17. A 18. A 19. D 20. C

21. D 22. B 23. D 24. A 25. D 26. A 27. C 28. A 29. A 30. A

31. D 32. C 33. A 34. C 35. A 36. D 37. C 38. D 39. D 40. B

41. D 42. B 43. A 44. A 45. D 46. C 47. B 48. C 49. A 50. D